

# Nello Esposito

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## REFERENCES

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### **Tullio Jappelli**

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## EDUCATION AND EMPLOYMENT

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- **PhD Internship**, Central Bank of Ireland, Dublin *Sep 2026 - August 2027*  
*Digital Euro Unit (DEU)*
- **PhD in Economics**, University of Naples Federico II *Nov 2022 - Feb 2027 (expected)*  
*Supervisor: Tullio Jappelli*
- **Visiting Student Researcher**, Stanford University *Sep 2024 - May 2025*  
*Host: Luigi Pistaferri*
- **MA in Economics**, University of Naples Federico II *Sep 2019 - Oct 2021*  
*Summa cum Laude*
- **Erasmus Program**, Goethe University Frankfurt *Nov 2020 - March 2021*

## RESEARCH FIELDS

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Household Finance, Labor Economics, Digital Euro

## SELECTED WORKING PAPERS

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### ***Employment Protection and Consumption: Evidence from Italy*** (Job Market Paper)

Leveraging an Italian labor market reform known as the *Jobs Act* (JA), I study how employment risk affects household consumption and labor supply. The JA reduced protection against individual termination only for workers hired on or after March 7, 2015, by firms with at least 15 employees. Using this time-based discontinuity in employment protection as exogenous variation in employment risk, I find that workers subject to the reform consume 8% less than workers hired through March

6, 2015, who were not exposed to the reform. By contrast, I find no significant effect on weekly hours worked. I use this empirical result to estimate a standard incomplete-markets model with ex-ante heterogeneity in employment risk. Replicating the empirical analysis in a simulated dataset and controlling for permanent income, I find that risk explains about one third of the reduced-form effect on consumption. Finally, I use the model to show that providing more generous unemployment insurance to workers exposed to the reform and less to unexposed workers, keeping the government's budget constraint fixed, maximizes welfare and reduces consumption inequality.

### ***Retirement and Portfolio Choices: Evidence from Italian Households***

(Joint with Nicol Barbieri, *University of Naples Federico II*)

This paper examines how retirement affects household portfolio allocation using rich panel data from the Italian Survey on Household Income and Wealth (SHIW) from 2012 to 2022. Exploiting exogenous variation in pension eligibility rules, we estimate a 2SLS with individual and time fixed effects to identify the causal impact of retirement on stock holdings. We find that when the head retires, households increase the share of financial wealth invested in stocks by more than 7 percentage points. This result contrasts sharply with standard portfolio choice theory, which predicts a decreasing equity share with age, but aligns with recent evidence of a negative relationship between background risk and households' stock market participation. When people retire, they are no longer exposed to employment risk. Therefore, they can afford to "replace" their background risk with financial risk if they are not close to the liquidity constraint. This effect is driven by wealthy retirees who had stable careers without unemployment spells. In contrast, poor liquidity-constrained retirees not only invest less in financial markets, but also reduce consumption upon retirement.

## **OTHER WORK IN PROGRESS**

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### ***Retirement and the Demographic Transition: a Survey Experiment***

Do individuals incorporate information about the national pension system into their retirement expectations and investment decisions? Using a novel representative sample of working Italians aged 15 to 75, this paper exploits exogenous variation in information by randomly exposing half of the sample to news about the pension system. I show that, on average, treated individuals revise their expected retirement age upward by 6 months and decrease their expected social security wealth by around 5%. Leveraging the Survey RCT as a first stage, I estimate the degree of substitutability between public pension wealth and private pension plans. I find very little substitutability, especially among individuals with low financial literacy.

### ***The Impact of Real Estate Subsidies on Consumption: the Italian "Superbonus 110"***

(Joint with Massimiliano Sfrogola, Bank of Italy, and University of Naples Federico II)

## **RESEARCH AND TEACHING EXPERIENCE**

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### **RESEARCH**

- **November 2021 - October 2022** Research Assistant, University of Naples Federico II  
*PI: Tullio Jappelli*

### **TEACHING**

Teaching Assistant:

- **Spring 2026** Advanced Macroeconomics (Master) University of Naples Federico II  
*PI: Tullio Jappelli*
- **Fall 2025** Macroeconomics (undergraduate) University of Naples Federico II  
*PIs: Tullio Jappelli, Francesco Simone Lucidi and Tommaso Oliviero*

- **Fall 2023** Macroeconomics (undergraduate) University of Naples Federico II  
*PIs: Tullio Jappelli, Saverio Simonelli and Tommaso Oliviero*

Guest Lecturer:

- **Spring 2026:** Retirement and the Demographic Transition.  
*Course: Economics of Pensions. PI: Chiara Lacava*
- **Fall 2025:** The Jobs Act and its impact on household savings.  
*Course: Labor Economics (Undergraduate). PI: Roberto Nisticò*
- **Spring 2025:** The Italian pension system.  
*Course: Public Finance (Undergraduate). PI: Carla Guerriero*

## SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

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- **June 2024** Visiting Student Researcher Scholarship – Italian Fulbright Commission
- **November 2022** PhD Scholarship - University of Naples Federico II
- **November 2020 – February 2021** Erasmus Exchange Scholarship
- **June 2019** Best Student Award, University of Naples Federico II

## PRESENTATIONS, CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOPS (including planned)

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**2026:** Ca' Foscari Internal Seminars, CSEF PhD Seminar, 21st Doctorissimes - Université Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne, HEC Liège Young Researchers Conference in Economics (HYRCE), EALE Tour 2026 - University of Naples Federico II (flash talk), 2nd Workshop on Frontiers in Measurement and Survey Methods - Università della Calabria (poster session), XXIX Workshop on Dynamic Macroeconomics - Vigo, 41st EEA Meeting - University College Dublin, 6th Sailing the Macro Workshop - Ortygia Foundation, 5th Naples School of Economics PhD and Post-Doctoral Workshop, 2nd LSE PhD Macro Workshop, 2026 CEPR Symposium (poster session)

**2025:** Stanford Macro Lunch, NSE Summer School (poster session), 5th Sailing the Macro Workshop - Ortygia Foundation, 40th AIEL Annual Conference - Università Milano-Bicocca, 4th Naples School of Economics PhD and Post-Doctoral Workshop, CSEF PhD Seminar, 23rd Brucchi Luchino Labor Economics Workshop - Università di Padova

**2024:** CSEF PhD Informal Seminar

## ORGANIZED WORKSHOPS

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- **2026:** 5th Naples School of Economics PhD and Post-Doctoral Workshop  
*Member of the Organizing Committee and Chair of the Macro and Development Sessions*
- **2025:** 4th Naples School of Economics PhD and Post-Doctoral Workshop  
*Member of the Organizing Committee and Chair of the Macro Session*
- **2024:** 3rd Naples School of Economics PhD and Post-Doctoral Workshop  
*Member of the Organizing Committee*

## SKILLS

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- **Languages:** English (*fluent*), Italian (*native*)
- **Programming:** Python, Matlab, Stata, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X, Dynare, R